



PATH 21

Your front door

A useful diagnostic. Email required. The follow-up sells path 1. Strangers become a list.

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Who this is for

You finished any earlier path. You need people you have never met.

Time to first

Same week you publish the form

Tools

First sale

The first email from someone you have never met.

Cash window

Feeds every other path

Leave this alone

A form, a PDF scorecard, MailerLite or Beehiiv.

A ‘free’ file that is only a sales letter. Passing this book off as if you wrote it.

What the door actually is

A front door is a useful diagnostic. Seven questions. They get a score and one next step. You get an email. The free file is useful even if they never buy. That is the deal you keep.

You may brand your own scorecard. You may not copy this book and sell it as yours. Build your door. Point it at your playbook.

What it is not It is not a 14-page “free guide” that is a sales letter with a checklist slapped on page 13. It is not this suite with your name on the cover. It is not a 40-field form that feels like a job application. It is not a fake score that always says “you need my \$47 file.”

If they can tell, in two minutes, that the PDF only exists to sell, you built a flyer. Flyers do not earn replies from strangers. Diagnostics do.

Why email is required A stranger who takes a score and disappears was never going to buy this week. That is fine. The door still has to be fair: they get the file instantly. You get a way to teach for a few notes, then ask. No hostage PDF. No “we’ll send it someday.” Instant, then a sequence that earns the ask.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you finished any earlier path. You have something to point at — usually path 1, a playbook — and you need people you have never met. Friends and DMs got you the first sales. The door is how strangers join that line without you hunting each one.

You can do this if - You can write seven questions that change the advice. If every answer leads to “buy my file,” the questions are fake.

- You can write a two-page PDF that still helps if they never pay you. - You will set up a 5–7 note sequence before you buy a single ad.

Skip this path if Skip it if you have nothing to sell yet. A door into an empty house is a hobby. Skip it if you planned to republish this suite as your lead magnet. Skip it if you will not include an unsubscribe. Skip it if you want a list more than you want to be useful — that motive leaks onto page one.

If you still cannot name the paid next step, go back to path 1 and finish the playbook. Then build the door that points at it.

The offer, named in one sentence

“Seven questions. A score. One next step. Free even if you never buy.”

That is the public offer. The private truth: the sequence teaches, then sells path 1. Both can be true if the PDF is real.

What they get - Seven questions, scored honestly. - A PDF that explains the score in plain language and gives one next step they can do this week without paying you. - Instant delivery. The file is in the thank-you email or the next screen, not in a queue you will “get to.”

What you get An email, permission to send a short sequence, and a score you may use to pick which next step to recommend. You do not get a right to spam daily. You do not get a right to sell them twelve things in note one.

What done looks like

Done is the first email from someone you have never met, sitting in a tool you control, with a score attached, and a PDF they already received. The sequence exists. Unsubscribe works. The paid playbook is linked in a later note, not in the first paragraph of the free file.

The fairness test Give the PDF to a friend and tell them not to buy anything. If they can still take one useful action this week, the door is honest. If they cannot, you wrote a sales letter and called it a scorecard. Rewrite until the friend has a next step that does not require a card.

Technical done Form live. PDF attached or linked immediately. Confirmation they expect. Sequence of 5–7 notes drafted, not “I’ll write them when people join.”

Pricing — the door is free, the house is not

The cash window is not a price on the PDF. The door feeds every other path. You do not charge for the seven questions.

Where money shows up - Path 1 playbook, usually \$19–\$47, asked for in note 5, 6, or 7 after you have taught. - Later: a service, a setup, a drop. Not in the first email.

What you never charge for here Do not charge \$9 for the scorecard and also call it free. Do not put the diagnostic behind a “tripwire” that is just the same sales letter. Free means free. Useful means useful without a receipt.

If someone asks to pay you for a live walkthrough of their results, that is a \$97–\$197 setup or a brief, sold as itself, after they already have the PDF. Do not hide that inside the magnet.

The first 72 hours

Day 1: questions plus PDF Write seven questions that change the advice. Not flattery. Each answer should send them toward a different next step: a playbook, a skill pack, “do not buy anything yet, finish one job,” or “talk to a person, not a file.” Build a two-to-four page PDF: how scoring

works, what each band means, one action per band that does not require paying you. Put your email in the footer as a human, not as a funnel.

Day 2: form live MailerLite, Beehiiv, or Tally into either. Fields: first name optional, email required, the seven questions. Thank-you page includes the PDF now. Test as a stranger from a second email. Confirm the file arrives. Confirm unsubscribe is one click.

Put the form above the paid button on your page. The door is the first thing a stranger sees. The playbook is the second.

Day 3: share once Share it once in a place you already help people. One post, one comment, one email to people who already know you. Do not buy ads. Do not spray five platforms. Watch whether anyone finishes the seven questions. If they abandon at question two, the questions are too cute or too many.

The path, step by step

Name the paid thing the door will eventually sell. Usually path 1. Write that on a sticky note so the sequence does not wander into a buffet.

Write seven questions that diagnose, not flatter. If two answers never change the PDF, delete one question and merge them.

Write a scoring key you could defend to a skeptical friend. Bands, not fake precision. “12–18: you need a pack, not a tool binge.”

Write the PDF so the free next step is real. Example: “Run one recurring job in a saved project this week. Do not buy a second subscription.”

Build the form. Email required. Instant file. No 40 fields. No “company size, budget, phone, mailing address.”

Hook the form to MailerLite or Beehiiv. Tag the score band if you can do it without a science project. If you cannot, send one sequence to everyone and mention bands in the PDF only.

Write 5–7 notes before anyone joins. Teach, then ask. Note 1 is the file and what to read. Notes 2–4 teach. Notes 5–6 ask for the playbook. Note 7 is a quiet close or a single service mention if that is truly the better fit.

Test-buy the path 1 checkout from a second email. The sequence must not point at a dead button.

Put the form above the paid button. Share once where you already help.

Reply to the first stranger like a person. One sentence. Not a six-link kit.

After ten subscribers, read where they drop. Fix questions, not your branding.

Only then consider a small ad budget. Sequence first. Ads on an empty sequence buy you unsubscribes you paid for.

A worked example: Noor's 7-question door

Noor finished a \$29 playbook: a 10-day content system for solo trades. Friends bought it. Strangers did not know Noor existed. Noor needed a door, not a second book.

The seven questions Noor used Each is multiple choice. Each changes the band.

In the last 30 days, how many times did you actually finish a job with AI, not just open a chat?
(0, 1–3, 4+)

Do you have one offer a stranger can buy this week without a call? (yes / not yet)

Where does a new customer usually find you? (word of mouth, Google, Instagram or TikTok, they don't)

What happens after someone messages you? (you reply yourself, a form, nothing for days)

Have you saved a prompt or a project you reuse, or do you start from a blank chat every time?
(saved / blank)

How many hours a week can you give this, honestly, with the job you already have? (under 2, 2–5, 6+)

If a file told you the next step, would you rather have a pack to run yourself, or a person to set it up? (pack / person)

Noor scores 0–2 points per question. Bands: 0–5 still-setup, 6–10 ready-for-a-pack, 11–14 ready-but-inconsistent. The PDF gives one action per band. Still-setup: write the offer sentence this week, do not buy a course. Ready-for-a-pack: run one saved project on a real job by Friday. Ready-but-inconsistent: pick one platform for 14 days. None of those actions require \$29. That is the deal Noor keeps.

The form and the sequence Email required. PDF on the thank-you page and in note 1. Noor brands it “Trades AI scorecard — Noor” — a scorecard, not this book. Notes: (1) here’s your file, read the band, do the action; (2) a one-job example from the playbook, no pitch; (3) why blank chat is expensive, still no pitch; (4) a mistake: posting on five platforms; (5) the playbook exists, \$29, link; (6) a customer sentence from a friend who used day 3; (7) last time the link will be in the sequence, plus unsubscribe reminder.

A stranger named Dell finishes the form on a Thursday. Score 8. Note 1 goes out at once. Dell does the “saved project” action. Note 5 sells. Dell buys the \$29 file Saturday. Noor never ran an ad. First email from someone Noor had never met: Thursday 4:12pm. That is the first sale of this path — the address, not the \$29. The \$29 is path 1 working through the door.

Copy you can actually send

The public line Seven questions. A score.
One next step. Free even if you never buy.

The post I made a short AI-readiness scorecard for [your people]. Seven questions, a score, one thing to do this week. It is useful if you never buy from me. Link: [form].

Note 1 (instant) Your scorecard is here: [PDF]. Read the band with your score. Do the one action this week. I’ll send a few short notes. You can leave any time — unsubscribe is at the bottom.

Notes 2–4, shape not script One job, one example, one mistake to avoid. No link to the paid file yet unless they ask.

Note 5, the ask If you want the full sequence I use for [job], it's a \$29 playbook: [link]. If the free action in the PDF is enough, stay with that. Either is fine.

Note 7, close Last note in this set. Playbook is still here: [link]. If you want a human setup instead, reply with the word SETUP and I'll tell you the price. If not, I'll write when I have something useful. Unsubscribe anytime.

What you do not write Do not paste chapters of this suite into your PDF. Do not put a fake 94/100 at the top. Do not forget the unsubscribe. The free file is a diagnostic, not a brochure that happens to have a score.

Week-by-week if you have a job

Week 1 Day 1: questions plus PDF. Day 2: form live, test as a stranger. Then write the 5–7 notes before any ads and before a second share. Share once in a place you already help people.

Week 2 Reply to humans. Fix the question people skip. Do not add a webinar. Count emails from strangers, not likes on the post.

Week 3–4 If ten people finished the form and the sequence is live, you may share again or spend a small amount on ads to the form — not to the paid button. If fewer than ten, the share was weak or the questions feel like a trap. Tighten the PDF's free action. Do not buy traffic to a flyer.

The quality bar

The bar is a file that still helps if they never pay, and a score that would change if they answered honestly.

Questions They change the advice. “Are you an ambitious entrepreneur?” does not. “Do you have one offer a stranger can buy this week?” does.

PDF Two to four pages. Band meanings. One free action each. Your name. No pasted chapters from someone else’s book. You may brand your own scorecard. You may not copy this book and sell it as yours.

Sequence Teaches first. Asks later. Unsubscribe always. Instant file, always.

Ethics you do not get to skip Passing this book off as if you wrote it is off limits. Selling this book as your own is off limits. Building a door that points at your playbook is the work.

What to count

First week - Form starts versus finishes. If half leave, you have too many questions or they smell a quiz trap. - Emails from people you have never met. That is the first sale of this path. - Whether the PDF link is clicked. If not, delivery is buried.

After 30 subscribers - Unsubscribe rate. Over 5 percent on the sequence means you asked too early or you were boring. Under 1 percent and zero clicks can mean nobody is reading — check the from-name. - Playbook click from notes 5–7. A few percent is real. Fifty percent means you only invited fans. - Replies. One genuine reply is worth twenty silent “opens.”

Do not buy a dashboard before you have thirty people. A spreadsheet with date, source, score band, bought-or-not is enough.

Objections you will hear — including your own

“People won’t give an email.” Some will not. They were not going to buy this month. The people who want the score will. Do not open the PDF to the whole internet and then wonder why you have no list. Email required is the deal.

“A free file should be a 40-page guide.” No. Long and useless is still useless. Seven questions and a tight PDF beat a stolen book with your logo.

“Can I just upload this suite as the magnet?” No. You may not copy this book and sell it as yours. You may not give it away as if you wrote it. Write a scorecard for your people. Point at your playbook.

“I should run ads on day one.” Not before the sequence exists. Paid traffic into silence is how you learn to hate lists.

“Fake scores convert better.” They convert once. Then they tell friends. Your name is small. Keep it clean.

“What if they only want the free thing?” Good. You kept the deal. Some of them buy in three months. Some never do. That is allowed.

What this feeds — and what feeds it

The door is last for a reason. It feeds every other path and it needs one of them first.

What must exist A paid next step, almost always path 1. Optionally a service or a setup if the diagnostic band says “person, not file.” The sequence should not invent a product you have not shipped.

What the list then feeds - Playbook sales without you DMing. - Later drops (path 17): you can tell a list about a Thursday live without begging the algorithm. - Research briefs, automations, custom projects — only as a reply offer, not as note 1. - A newsletter if you want one. The door can be the same form.

What the door must never feed A replica of this suite with your name on it. A “free” file that is only a sales letter. A purchased list. Those rot.

Mistakes that kill the door

Buying ads before the sequence exists. A 40-field form. Fake scores. Forgetting the unsubscribe. Those still kill it.

The rest - A PDF that is only a sales letter. - Passing this book off as if you wrote it, or selling this book as your own. - “We’ll send the file in 24 hours” as a drip trick. - Asking for the sale in paragraph one of the free file. - Daily blasts. - Questions that always output the same band. - Sharing on five platforms before you tested delivery from a second email.

If you catch yourself rewriting the PDF to mention the paid file more than the free action, you slipped. Put the paid file back in notes 5–7.

Tools — only what you need

A form, a PDF scorecard, MailerLite or Beehiiv. That is the stack.

Form Tally, the Beehiiv form, or MailerLite’s. Email required. Seven questions. Thank-you with the file.

PDF Google Docs export. Two to four pages. Your name, the year, a sentence that the file is free even if they never buy.

Sequence 5–7 notes in the same tool. Plain text is fine. No twenty-pixel buttons in every paragraph.

Do not add yet Do not add a webinar platform, a quiz app with 14 branches, or a CRM. Thirty strangers do not need HubSpot. They need a file and a way out.

Checklist

You finished an earlier path; the paid next step exists

Seven questions that change the advice

Scoring key you can defend

PDF with one free action per band

You did not copy this book into the PDF

Email required, not 40 fields

Instant delivery, tested from a second inbox

Unsubscribe works

5–7 notes written before you share widely

Teach first, ask later (notes 5–7)

Form sits above the paid button

Shared once where you already help

No ads until the sequence exists

First stranger email treated like a person

FAQ

Do I have to use seven questions? Seven is enough to change advice and short enough to finish on a phone. Five can work. Forty cannot.

What if I do not have a playbook yet? Do not build the door. Finish path 1, or another path with a named next step. An empty house does not need a nicer porch.

Can I brand the scorecard with my business name? Yes. You may brand your own scorecard. You may not copy this book and sell it as yours, and you may not give this book away as if you wrote it.

MailerLite or Beehiiv? Whichever you will actually open. Beehiiv if you also want a public letter. MailerLite if you want simple forms. Both handle unsubscribe. Use that feature.

Should the PDF include my prices? A line at the end is allowed: “If you want the full 10-day file, it lives here.” The body of the PDF should still work with that line deleted.

How fast is “instant”? On the thank-you screen and in the first email. Not “check your promotions tab in a few hours while we wait to look hungry.”

What is the first sale on this path? The first email from someone you have never met. Cash from the playbook is path 1 using the door. Count both. Do not pretend the list is failing because the \$29 did not happen on day one.

Can I sell the diagnostic as a \$9 product? Then it is not this path. This path is a free door. If you want a paid score, that is a small file on path 9, and you still need a free door later.

What about GDPR and consent? Say what they are joining, in one sentence, under the button. Include unsubscribe. Do not buy lists. Do not scrape emails out of comments.

When do I add ads? After the sequence exists, delivery works, and a handful of strangers have finished the form. Until then you are paying to learn that your PDF is a flyer.